



External Hard drives

Portable Hard drives

Western Digital Media Centre 250 GB

Specs: 16X DVD+R, 16X DVD-R, 4X DVD+RW, 4X DVD-RW, 2.4X DVD+R DL, 32X CD-R and 24X CD-RW

Our Verdict: This is the best-performing Dual-Layer DVD writer your money can buy. It supports over-speed burning, and in our tests, posted some of the fastest write speeds.

Runner-up: Maxtor One Touch 250GB



Compact Hard drives

Freecom FDH-2 PRO 80 GB

Specs: 1.8 inch platter, 175 gms, 2MB buffer and USB 2.0 interface

Our Verdict: With the lowest price per MB, one-touch button for backup, excellent looks and stable performance, it took our Best Buy Gold award in this category of hard drives.

Runner-up:

Transcend StoreJet TS06SJ25



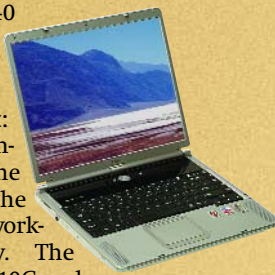
Laptops

Workhorse MSI MegaBook M510C

Specs: Pentium M 1.5 GHz, 256 MB, 15" screen, 40 GB hard drive, combo drive

Our Verdict: Blazing performance saw the M510C take the crown in the workhorse category. The Megabook M510C also offers a good configuration for the price.

Runner-up: Wipro CP

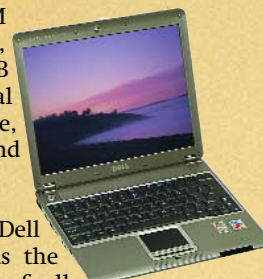


Runner-up: Compaq X1237AP and Toshiba Satellite M30

Ultra-portable Dell Latitude X300

Specs: Pentium M 1.2 GHz, 384 MB, 12" screen, 30 GB hard disk, external USB combo drive, docking station and an extra battery

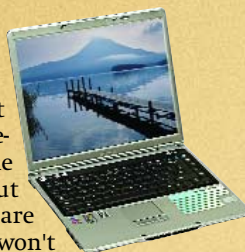
Our Verdict: The Dell Latitude X300 has the slimmest profile of all, and is compact enough to be carried around easily. It comes bundled with all the necessary bells and whistles, and has an assortment of accessories to choose from.



Lifestyle LG LM-50

Specs: Pentium M 1.5 GHz, 256 MB, 15" screen, 60 GB hard drive, combo drive

Our Verdict: The LM-50 will appeal with its good looks. An excellent performer in its category, it posted some good scores in our tests. Features are limited, but one won't find any essential features missing.

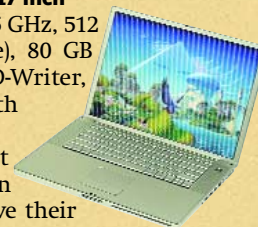


Runner-up: Fujitsu Lifebook S2020

Apple G4 PowerBook 17 inch

Specs: Power PC G4 1.5 GHz, 512 MB, 17" screen (Wide), 80 GB hard disk, DVD-Writer, FireWire 800, Bluetooth

Our Verdict: The best designed notebooks in the business, they have their own charm. We praise it for its sheer beauty, not to forget the performance.



Flashback To December 2000

Iomega 2 GB Jaz

Specs: SCSI Drive

Evolution: Four years ago, the 2 GB Jaz drive was the in thing. Today an 80 GB ultra-compact hard drive is it. Comparing sizes: you can make out the obvious difference—the ultra-compact drive is much smaller than the Jaz drive. The 2 GB Jaz was priced at Rs 21,000 then, so is the Freecom FDH-2 PRO 80 GB. Effectively, the price per MB has dropped 40 times.

Zenith 21A

Specs: 1 GHz Pentium 3 processor, 128 MB RAM, 10 GB hard disk, S3-based graphics and CD-ROM

Evolution: Laptop hardware has come a long way. The old Pentium III chips have metamorphosed. Today you see optimised fast Pentium M processors, extremely good graphics and four hours of juice to keep your work in progress when on the move. The Zenith 21A then was priced 1 lakh; today you can buy a powerhouse laptop for that price.

